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MOHAMED MEETS SPECIAL ENVOY TO RUSSIAN PRESIDENT

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan receives Kirill Dmitriev, Special Envoy to the Russian President and CEO of the Russian Direct Investment Fund at Qasr Al Shati. During the meeting, Dmitriev conveyed the greetings of Russian President Vladimir Putin, along with his appreciation to the UAE for hosting the trilateral talks involving the US, Russia, and Ukraine.

SEE ALSO P11

UAE says no attacks on Iran from its territory

Country will also not provide logistical support for attacks

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE will not allow attacks on Iran to be launched from its territory, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) reaffirmed in a statement yesterday.

The ministry said it “has reaffirmed the United Arab Emirates’ commitment to not allowing its airspace, territory or waters to be used in any hostile military actions against Iran,”

WAM reported. The UAE also refuses to provide logistical support for attacks, the statement said, adding that “dialogue, de-escalation, adherence to international law, and respect for state sovereignty” are the best ways to address “current crises.”

Tensions high

Tensions between Iran and the United States remain high due to recent protests that have erupted across Iran.

Last week, US President Donald Trump said a US “armada” is heading towards West Asia with a focus on Iran.

The US military buildup follows Trump’s recent endorsement of Iran’s anti-government

protests. Trump’s warnings to Tehran were against killing protesters or restarting its nuclear programme.

The protests began in late December, sparked by economic grievances, but turned into a mass movement against the Islamic republic, with huge street rallies for several days from January 8.

The UK Embassy in Doha recently confirmed that the Royal Air Force’s (RAF) joint Typhoon squadron with Qatar, 12 Squadron, has deployed to the Gulf for defensive purposes amid heightened regional tensions, under the UK-Qatar Defence Assurance Agreement.

SEE ALSO P10

Emirates and Etihad flights hit by US storm

RECORD SNOWFALL IN TORONTO AFTER STORM MOVES INTO CANADA

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Flights between the UAE, Qatar and the United States continued to face disruption after a severe winter storm battered the US East Coast, triggering airport closures, long delays and cancellations on some of the busiest transatlantic routes.

There were early signs of relief yesterday. According to a CNN report, the storm has exited the mid-Atlantic region, allowing airports and airlines to begin a gradual recovery. Washington Dulles International Airport said yesterday flights would slowly resume, with weather conditions improving.

The storm was moving yesterday through the US northeast and southeast Canada, with some areas in Toronto seeing record-breaking snowfall.

At least 20 states and the US capital Washington have declared states of emergency, as 17 people were killed yesterday.

Cancellations, delays

Dubai-based Emirates confirmed it had cancelled two New York services scheduled for yesterday. The airline said it continues to closely monitor the situation, adding that flights scheduled for today are expected to operate as planned.

Etihad Airways said one Abu Dhabi-New York service oper-

ated earlier yesterday, but with a significant delay. The airline cautioned that weather conditions remain uncertain and warned that further delays or cancellations may occur if required.

On Sunday, Etihad cancelled all flights to and from New York’s John F. Kennedy International Airport and Washington Dulles International Airport. The airline said all other services to the United States and Canada are currently planned to operate as scheduled. Qatar Airways services into New York also experienced lengthy delays. Air India cancelled all flights to and from New York and Newark on Sunday and yesterday.

Aviation experts warn that knock-on delays could continue even after airports reopen, due to aircraft positioning challenges, crew duty limits and congestion at major hubs. Travellers flying between the Gulf and the US are being advised to check flight status regularly, prepare for short-notice changes and allow extra time for rebooking as airlines prioritise safety amid the ongoing storm.

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